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      <abstract>Nationwide counts of eagles were coordinated by the National Wildlife
      Federation from 1979 until 1992, when the Bureau of Land Management's Raptor Research
      and Technical Assistance Center assumed responsibility for overseeing the count.
      Responsibility for count coordination was transferred to the National Biological Survey
      (1993-1996) and later assumed by the U.S. Geological Survey (USGS), Forest and
      Rangeland Ecosystem Science Center, Snake River Field Station. In April 2007, the USGS
      established a partnership with the U.S. Army Corps of Engineers (USACE) to maintain the
      long-term, national coordination of the survey, data analysis, and reporting. Observers
      conduct surveys on predetermined routes during the first 2 weeks of January each year,
      usually on 1 of 2 target days. Most survey participants are volunteer employees of
      state or federal conservation agencies, but private volunteers also participate in the
      survey. Coordinators from each state are responsible for organizing local counts,
      enlisting survey participants, and compiling data to eliminate duplicate sightings and
      overlapping routes. Sizes of survey routes vary from single fixed points to 150 miles.
      Approximately 44% of the surveys are conducted from vehicles. 18% are conducted from
      fixed wing aircraft; 8% are collected from boats; and 7% are conducted by helicopter.
      Due to weather and staffing limitations, not all routes are surveyed every year.
      Twenty-five states identified and began surveying routes in 1986; other states did not
      begin surveys until the mid-1990s. Some states stopped participating in the count in
      the 1990s. The number of states participating each year has ranged from 25 to 41, and
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      Steenhof, Laura Bond, Kirk K. Bates, and Lynda , 2002, Trends in midwinter counts of
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      location of the routes has emphasized river stretches and water bodies where bald
      eagles are known to occur. These data are records of golden eagles associated with
      routes used to survey for bald eagles. These survey routes are not randomly selected,
      so we do not know if the routes used for this dataset are representative of the
      contiguous 48 states. The routes are likely biased towards states and portions of
      states where organizations and individuals were committed to long-term, consistent data
      collection. The data were compiled from individual state level spreadsheets acquired
      from the State Midwinter Bald Eagle Coordinators. Data were assembled into a Microsoft
      Access database. All routes that had valid geographic coordinates and at least one
      golden eagle observation were retrieved from the database for entry into this dataset.
      Route numbers and route placenames were reviewed for consistency. Missing place names
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